SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

AN ASSESSMENT OF THE PREPAREDNESS OF CONVENTION FACILITIES IN BUTUAN CITY

A Thesis Proposal Presented To
The Faculty of
College of Tourism and Hospitality Management

In Partial Requirements for the Degree

By

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SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
College of Tourism and Hospitality Management

CERTIFICATE OF RESEARCH APPROVAL

This thesis entitled **"AN ASSESMENT OF THE PREPAREDNESS IN CONVENTION AND FACILITIES IN BUTUAN CITY."** presented and submitted by **MARIEL M. DELFIN, JAN CEASARY A. CASTRODES, HANNAH SHARMAINE MONTANO, ANGEL MAE B. FABROA, MADRIAN JOSEPH AVILA, RECAH JHOANA L. ENCIO, JONATHAN JR. C. PENADOS** in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of **BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN TOURISM MANAGEMENT** is hereby accepted and recommended for Oral Examination.

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ABSTRACT

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III. FINDINGS

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IV. RECOMMENDATIONS

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RESEARCH DESIGN -refers To The Specific Approach Use In The Research E.x. DESCRIPTIVE QUALITATIVE

Objectives
- **Write a short introduction of your paper. Provide the direction of the study and nuances.**

Methodology
- **Provide the specific method that was used in your paper and the important details such as how did you do it.**

Findings
- **Highlight the significant findings of your paper.**

Recommendation
- **Just highlight the primary recommendation**

KEYWORDS: PROVIDE AT LEAST 5

Check guidelines for writing an abstract for further details. Max of 250 words from objective 1-5

Write it in paragraph form narrative. See sample IN YOUR DISCUSSION

DEDICATION

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS



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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

Meetings, Incentives, Conventions, and Events (MICE) is one of the most dynamic sectors of global tourism, contributing significantly to economic growth, destination competitiveness, and international collaboration (Galapate et al., 2024). Globally, the MICE industry generates employment, stimulates hotel and transportation demand, and attracts high-value business travelers. In the post-pandemic period, destinations are also expected to provide safe, technologically capable, and resilient event environments, making venue preparedness a critical concern worldwide.

International studies emphasize that MICE readiness goes beyond physical infrastructure and includes organizational systems, technology integration, and staff capability. For instance, the Lao National Convention Center demonstrates how promising facilities may still face operational and coordination gaps (Phanthanousy & Sribenjachot, 2021). In Indonesia, MICE practitioners report skills mismatches and the need for competency-based training aligned with regional standards (Erfinda et al., 2023). Similarly, research in Malaysia shows uneven adoption of hybrid-event technologies and safety protocols, reflecting differences in digital readiness and operational resilience (Sah et al., 2025). These studies highlight the importance of assessing venue readiness holistically, covering physical setup, technology, and event services (Klinmalai & Kaewlai, 2024; Mair & Smith, 2021). Within Southeast Asia, these global developments influence how destinations compete in the regional MICE market. ASEAN destinations are

increasingly evaluated based on their compliance with venue standards, technological capacity, and service quality. This regional context underscores the need for local destinations to align their facilities with international and ASEAN expectations to remain competitive.

In the Philippines, the Meetings, Incentives, Conventions, and Exhibitions Roadmap 2030 seek to position the country as a leading MICE destination in Asia through venue improvement, workforce development, and standardization (Blanquisco, 2024). However, studies reveal uneven readiness across local destinations. Pandemic-related disruptions caused widespread cancellations, revenue losses, and workforce reductions, leading many venues to adopt hybrid and micro-event formats (Bagaoisan et al., 2021). Other studies report gaps in digital infrastructure (Disimulacion, 2021), limited technology integration in Batangas venues (Hernandez, 2023), and service-quality concerns related to staff conditions in Davao City (Hinlayagan et al., 2022a). These findings suggest that while national MICE initiatives are progressing, preparedness at the local level remains inconsistent. This situation is more pronounced in Mindanao, where empirical studies on MICE venue readiness remain limited. Specifically, there is a lack of research examining which dimensions of readiness physical setup, technology utilization, and event services are adequately developed or remain deficient in Mindanao-based venues. Existing studies rarely provide focused assessments of these dimensions, particularly in emerging cities, resulting in an unclear understanding of local preparedness conditions.

In Butuan City presents strong potential as a MICE destination in the Caraga Region due to its strategic location and growing tourism and events activity. However, there is a need to examine whether its convention and event facilities are prepared in terms of physical setup, technology utilization, and event services, as these dimensions have not been empirically studied in the local context. Addressing this gap is essential to determine whether Butuan City's facilities meet current industry standards and can support sustainable MICE development.

The significance of this study lies in its ability to provide focused, evidence-based insights for key stakeholders. For local government units, the findings may support informed planning and policy decisions related to MICE development. For venue owners and managers, the study can identify specific areas for improvement in facilities, technology, and service delivery. For the College of Tourism and Hospitality Management of Saint Michael College of Caraga, the study will serve as an academic reference that enhances student learning and supports community-based research. By addressing a clearly defined research gap, this study contributes to a better understanding of MICE facility preparedness in Butuan City.

This study is important because the success of Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, and Exhibitions (MICE) activities largely depends on the preparedness of convention and event facilities, yet there is currently no systematic assessment of such preparedness in Butuan City. While the city has been increasingly used for meetings, trainings, conferences, and large gatherings, there is limited empirical evidence to determine

whether its convention facilities meet acceptable standards in terms of physical set-up, technology utilization, and event services. Without this information, venue operators and local tourism planners rely on assumptions rather than data-driven decisions, which may result in service gaps, safety risks, and reduced competitiveness. Given the growing expectations of event organizers and participants, particularly in areas of safety, digital capability, and service coordination, there is a clear need to evaluate the actual readiness of these facilities. Conducting this study will help identify strengths and deficiencies, provide a factual basis for improvements, and support Butuan City's potential to develop as a competitive MICE destination. Thus, this research is necessary to ensure quality, safety, and sustainability in the city's convention and events sector.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

Preparedness in the MICE industry refers to a venue's ability to conduct events safely, efficiently, and consistently through the integration of physical infrastructure, technological capability, and effective event services. Contemporary literature consistently treats preparedness as a multidimensional construct, emphasizing that no single element alone can ensure successful event delivery (Litvinova-Kulikova et al., 2023; Liu et al., 2022). Instead, preparedness emerges from the interaction of structural readiness, operational systems, and human resources.

International studies reinforce this integrated perspective. Phanthanousy and Sribenjachot (2021) found that even modern convention centers may experience operational challenges when coordination systems and service processes are weak.

Similarly, Erfinda et al. (2023) argue that MICE readiness in ASEAN destinations depends not only on physical facilities but also on workforce competence and alignment with regional standards. These findings are consistent with Klinmalai and Kaewlai (2024), who emphasize that physical set-up, technology, and service delivery must function together to enhance destination competitiveness.

In the Philippine context, preparedness has become more critical following the COVID-19 pandemic. Studies report that venues were required to adopt health protocols, hybrid formats, and digital solutions, revealing gaps in technology infrastructure and service capacity (Bagaoisan et al., 2021; Disimulacion, 2021). Hernandez (2023) further notes that many provincial venues lag behind major cities in terms of digital readiness and coordinated service systems. Collectively, these studies establish preparedness as a central framework for evaluating convention facilities and justify the need for localized assessments such as the present study.

Preparedness of Physical Set-Up

Preparedness of physical set-up refers to the extent to which the physical environment of a convention or event facility is capable of supporting safe, efficient, and well-organized Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, and Exhibitions (MICE) activities. In the context of contemporary event management, physical readiness is no longer limited to the availability of space but includes compliance with safety standards, flexibility of layout, ventilation quality, cleanliness, and accessibility. Hernandez (2023) emphasizes that post-pandemic MICE operations require venues to redesign physical spaces to

promote safety, manage crowd movement, and enhance participant confidence. This view is reinforced by Melly et al. (2023), who argue that adaptable spatial design and proper airflow are now core indicators of venue readiness.

Several studies highlight that physical set-up serves as the structural foundation upon which other dimensions of preparedness operate. An et al. (2021) explain that inadequacies in space configuration and room design often result in operational inefficiencies, even when technology and services are adequate. Aguilar and Hernandez (2025) similarly found that destinations aspiring to become competitive MICE hubs must first ensure that their physical facilities meet national and international standards. These studies collectively indicate that physical set-up directly affects safety, satisfaction, and operational performance.

Meetings and Function Rooms

Meetings and function rooms are the primary venues where formal MICE activities take place; hence, their preparedness is critical to overall event success. Hernandez (2023) notes that venues in the Philippines have increasingly focused on improving ventilation, sanitation, and layout flexibility within function rooms to meet post-pandemic requirements. These adjustments allow organizers to accommodate varying event sizes and formats while maintaining safety and comfort.

Supporting this, An et al. (2021) demonstrate that room size, seating configuration, and availability of audiovisual infrastructure significantly influence participant satisfaction and operational efficiency. Well-prepared function rooms allow smooth transitions

between sessions, support hybrid event requirements, and minimize disruptions. Aguilar and Hernandez (2025) further emphasize that properly designed function rooms enhance a venue's credibility and attractiveness to event organizers, especially for large-scale conventions and conferences.

Meeting Rooms and Public Areas

Meeting rooms and public areas play a vital role in shaping the overall event experience, as they influence crowd flow, comfort, and safety. Hernandez (2023) explains that improvements in corridors, lobbies, restrooms, and holding areas help reduce congestion and improve compliance with safety protocols. These spaces serve as transition points where poor design can lead to confusion and crowding.

International research supports this observation. Drakeley and Brown (2022) highlight that effective crowd management depends on wide circulation paths, visible signage, and organized queuing systems. De-Ville et al. (2025) further stress that adequate ventilation in public areas is essential to prevent discomfort and health risks during large gatherings. Collectively, these studies show that public areas must be spacious, well-ventilated, and clearly organized to support preparedness.

Safety, Security, and Emergency Facilities

Safety, security, and emergency facilities are fundamental components of physical preparedness because they protect participants and ensure continuity of operations during unexpected incidents. Hernandez (2023) explains that the presence of emergency

exits, fire protection equipment, isolation areas, and trained personnel has become a basic expectation among event organizers and attendees.

Evangelista and Ylagan (2022) support this view by emphasizing that emergency preparedness requires both physical resources and trained staff capable of responding effectively to medical and safety incidents. International guidelines also stress the importance of clear evacuation plans, regular drills, and coordinated emergency procedures to maintain venue resilience (Schütte et al., 2024). These findings confirm that safety and emergency facilities are integral to physical set-up preparedness.

Utilization of Technology

Utilization of technology refers to the extent to which convention and event facilities employ technological systems to support efficient, reliable, and modern MICE operations. Hernandez (2023) describes technology utilization as a core operational requirement that influences communication, program flow, and overall event quality. As events increasingly adopt hybrid and digitally supported formats, technological readiness has become inseparable from preparedness.

Zamzuri et al. (2023) argue that technology enhances operational efficiency by streamlining registration, improving communication, and supporting real-time coordination. However, they caution that technology is only effective when supported by trained personnel and reliable infrastructure. This highlights the need to view technology utilization as both a technical and human capability.

Light and Audio-Visual Operations

Light and audio-visual operations are essential technological components that directly affect information delivery and participant engagement. Hernandez (2023) emphasizes that dependable lighting systems, clear sound quality, and well-maintained audiovisual equipment are critical for preventing disruptions during events. Inadequate AV systems often lead to delays, communication breakdowns, and reduced attendee satisfaction.

Adeyemo Babalola (2024) and Karnadipa et al. (2022) further explain that hybrid and virtual event formats require high-quality cameras, microphones, projectors, and stable internet connectivity. These systems must be supported by trained technical staff capable of monitoring and resolving issues in real time. Their findings suggest that AV preparedness now extends beyond equipment availability to include coordination and redundancy planning.

Power and Air-Conditioning Systems

Power and air-conditioning systems support both technological operations and participant comfort, making them vital indicators of preparedness. Hernandez (2023) explains that uninterrupted power supply is necessary to maintain lighting, audiovisual equipment, digital platforms, and emergency systems during events. Power interruptions can severely disrupt MICE activities and compromise safety.

Studies by Marqusee and Stringer (2023) emphasize the importance of backup power systems such as generators and automatic transfer switches to ensure operational

continuity. Meanwhile, Alghamdi and Krarti (2025) highlight that efficient HVAC systems improve comfort, air quality, and energy performance, particularly in large venues. These studies show that power and air-conditioning reliability directly supports event continuity and attendee satisfaction.

Other Services

Other services include Wi-Fi connectivity, contactless registration, digital payment systems, and electronic verification tools. Quimba et al. (2021) note that digital readiness at the national and organizational level influences the effectiveness of these services. Limitations in connectivity or system integration can reduce operational efficiency and user satisfaction.

Nilufar et al. (2025) argue that digital platforms and mobile applications enhance event experiences by streamlining processes and enabling real-time engagement. These services support modern expectations for convenience, safety, and efficiency, reinforcing their importance in technology utilization preparedness.

Event Services

Event services refer to the systems, personnel, and coordinated activities provided by a convention or event facility before, during, and after an event to ensure smooth operations and positive participant experiences. In MICE settings, event services function as the operational backbone that connects physical facilities and technological systems with actual event execution. Hernandez (2023) emphasizes that even well-equipped

venues may fail to deliver successful events if service coordination and staff performance are inadequate, highlighting the central role of event services in overall preparedness.

Several authors agree that event services must be proactive rather than reactive. Gooding et al. (2022) explain that effective service delivery depends on advance planning, clear role assignments, and continuous communication among departments. Their study shows that venues with structured coordination systems experience fewer operational disruptions and respond more effectively to unexpected changes. Genove and Tayco (2024) reinforce this view, noting that service quality improves when venues institutionalize feedback mechanisms and use post-event evaluations to guide service improvement. These findings suggest that preparedness in event services is an ongoing process rather than a one-time arrangement.

Event services have also evolved to reflect broader industry expectations, including sustainability, inclusivity, and destination branding. Firman Sinaga et al. (2020) observe that many MICE venues are integrating environmentally responsible practices such as waste reduction, digital documentation, and coordinated transportation. Although budget limitations and client preferences sometimes constrain full implementation, these practices increasingly influence how event services are evaluated. Similarly, Fernali and Disimulacion (2024) argue that integrating local culture, food, and creative tourism elements into events enhances participant engagement and strengthens destination identity, thereby expanding the scope of event services beyond basic operational support.

Coordination and Service Improvement

Coordination and service improvement refer to the ability of venue personnel and departments to work together efficiently to deliver seamless event experiences. Hernandez (2023) explains that coordination involves aligning front desk services, technical teams, housekeeping, security, and food and beverage units under a unified operational plan. When coordination is weak, service gaps emerge, resulting in delays, miscommunication, and participant dissatisfaction.

Gooding et al. (2022) stress that coordination improves when organizations establish standardized procedures and shared goals across departments. Their research indicates that clear communication channels and defined responsibilities reduce errors and enhance responsiveness during complex events. Genove and Tayco (2024) further highlight that continuous service improvement depends on how venues collect, analyze, and act on client feedback. Venues that institutionalize learning from previous events demonstrate higher adaptability and preparedness.

International perspectives support these findings. Velin et al. (2021) show that poorly coordinated services can limit accessibility and participation, particularly for international delegates facing logistical, language, or mobility barriers. This underscores the importance of coordination not only for efficiency but also for inclusivity. Overall, coordination and service improvement are critical indicators of a venue's readiness to manage diverse and large-scale MICE activities.

Staff Services

Staff services refer to the competence, professionalism, communication skills, and safety behavior of personnel involved in MICE operations. Staff members serve as the primary interface between the venue and its clients, making their performance a key determinant of perceived preparedness. Hernandez (2023) notes that well-trained and motivated staff enhance event flow, enforce safety protocols effectively, and address participant concerns promptly.

Kim et al. (2021) emphasize that a strong safety climate within organizations increases compliance with safety measures and encourages proactive behavior among employees. Their study shows that transparent management communication and supportive organizational culture strengthen staff reliability, especially during periods of heightened risk such as public health emergencies. Kumar and Samtani (2021) similarly find that employee appearance, communication style, and attentiveness significantly influence satisfaction and loyalty in hotel-based MICE settings.

Recent research also highlights the role of workforce stability in service preparedness. Litvinova-Kulikova et al. (2023) explain that high staff turnover and precarious employment arrangements can weaken institutional knowledge and service consistency. Wiengarten et al. (2021) caution that reliance on temporary or contractual labor may increase operational risks unless supported by strong supervision and clear procedures. These findings suggest that investment in staff training and retention is essential for sustaining preparedness in event services.

Age

Age influences how individuals perceive safety, technology use, and participation in MICE events. Hernandez (2023) explains that younger respondents tend to adapt more easily to digital platforms and hybrid event formats, while older participants prioritize clarity, safety, and predictability. Haghani et al. (2023) further note that older adults exhibit higher risk awareness and stricter adherence to safety protocols, whereas younger adults value convenience and flexibility. These differences make age a relevant factor in preparedness assessment.

Studies also indicate that age affects satisfaction and engagement. An et al. (2021) show that age influences how participants evaluate service quality and physical comfort, emphasizing the need for inclusive design. Martín-Rojo and Gaspar-González (2025) add that digitalization affects age groups differently, with younger participants adapting more readily to apps and QR-based systems, while older participants benefit from clear guidance and on-site assistance.

Sex

Sex is considered a relevant demographic variable because men and women may differ in their perceptions of safety, service quality, and physical environments. Hernandez (2023) found that variations in comfort levels and expectations influence how respondents evaluate venue preparedness. Millán et al. (2024) support this view, noting that gender-based differences in service perception become more pronounced in technologically integrated MICE settings.

Gender inclusivity also shapes preparedness. Poquiz et al. (2023) emphasize that equitable workplace policies, anti-harassment measures, and inclusive facility design contribute to safer and more comfortable environments for all participants. These factors indirectly influence how preparedness is perceived across sexes, highlighting the need for gender-responsive event planning.

Employment Status

Employment status affects familiarity with event processes and expectations of venue performance. Hernandez (2023) explains that employed professionals who frequently attend or organize events tend to apply structured standards when evaluating preparedness, while those with less exposure rely more on basic comfort cues. Disimulacion (2021) further demonstrates that employment instability in the MICE sector influences service delivery and organizational readiness.

Technological change has also reshaped employment expectations. Liu et al. (2022) argue that digital competence and adaptability are now core employment skills in the MICE industry. Litvinova-Kulikova et al. (2023) add that hybrid and project-based employment arrangements, while flexible, may weaken training continuity if not managed properly. These findings show that employment status provides important context for understanding preparedness perceptions.

Large Type of Event Handled

The largest type of event handled influences the complexity of operations and preparedness requirements. Hernandez (2023) and Joseph and Calinao (2023) explain

that large-scale events such as conventions, exhibitions, and conferences require stronger coordination systems, flexible physical layouts, advanced technology, and heightened safety measures compared to smaller meetings. Lou and Huang (2023) further show that exhibition performance is closely linked to the quality of exhibition hall facilities, reinforcing the importance of scale-sensitive preparedness.

Average Number of Attendees

The number of attendees serves as a practical indicator of event size and operational demand. Gandarosa (2023) notes that higher attendance levels necessitate increased staffing, enhanced crowd management, and more robust technological support. Hernandez (2023) adds that while headcount alone does not determine preparedness, it interacts with event type to shape service and coordination requirements. These studies indicate that attendance size is a meaningful contextual variable in assessing preparedness.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

This study is anchored on Donabedian's Structure–Process–Outcome (SPO) Framework (1966), which explains service quality and preparedness by examining how available resources (structure) influence operational activities (process) and result in measurable outcomes (outcome). The framework is appropriate for this research because the study focuses on assessing the preparedness of convention facilities in Butuan City, which depends on the interaction between facility conditions, operational practices, and overall readiness.

In this study, the Structure domain corresponds to the Preparedness in Physical Set-up of convention facilities. This domain represents the foundational conditions necessary for hosting MICE events and is operationalized through the following indicators: meetings and function rooms, meeting rooms and public areas, and safety, security, and emergency facilities. These structural elements determine whether convention facilities are physically capable of supporting safe, organized, and efficient events.

The Process domain refers to how operations and services are carried out within convention facilities. Consistent with the schematic diagram, this study operationalizes the process domain through two variables: Utilization of Technology and Event Services. Technology utilization includes lighting and audiovisual operations, power and air-conditioning systems, and other technological services, which support event delivery and technical reliability. Event services include coordination and service improvement and staff services, reflecting how personnel, systems, and procedures are implemented before, during, and after events. These process variables explain how physical resources are transformed into effective event operations.

The Outcome domain represents the Preparedness of Convention Facilities in Butuan City, which is the main focus of this study and directly reflects the research title. Preparedness is assessed based on the combined performance of physical setup, technology utilization, and event services. In line with Donabedian's framework, higher levels of preparedness are expected when convention facilities have adequate structural conditions and effective operational processes.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

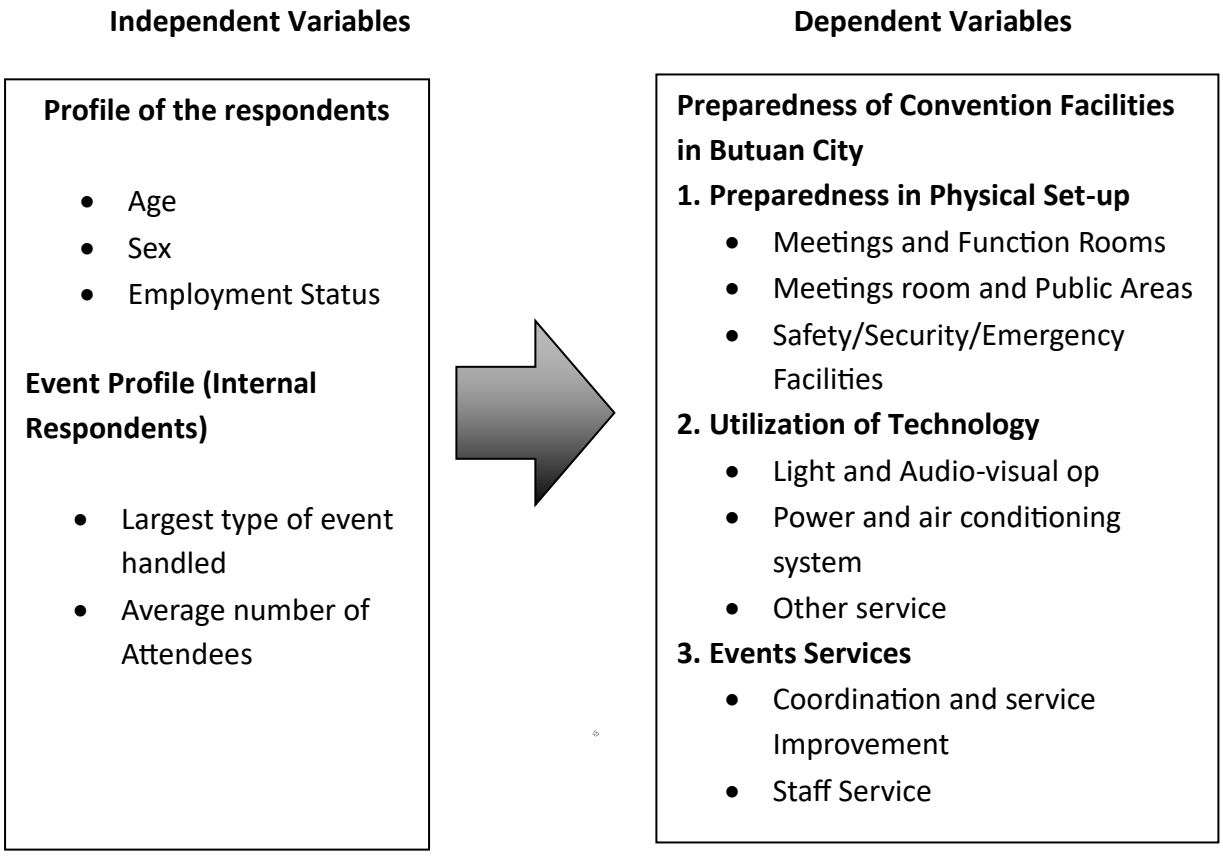


Figure 1. The Schematic Diagram shows the relationship between the dependent and independent variables.

1.5 Statement of the Problem/ Objectives of the Study

This study will assess the preparedness of convention and event facilities in Butuan City in accommodating Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, and Exhibitions (MICE) events. Specifically, it will seek to answer the following questions:

1. What is the demographic profile of the respondents in terms of:

    1.1 Age

    1.2 Sex; and

    2.3 Employment Status?

2. What is the event profile of the internal respondents in terms of:

    2.1 Largest type of event handled; and

    2.2 Average number of attendees?

3. What is the level of preparedness of convention and event facilities in terms of physical setup, particularly regarding:

    3.1 Meetings and Function rooms

    3.2 Meeting and public areas; and

    3.3 Safety, security, and emergency facilities?

4. What is the extent of utilization of technology in terms of:

    4.1 Light and audio-visual operations

    4.2 Power and air conditioning; and

    4.3 Other technological service?

5. What is the extent or level of events and services offered by the facilities in terms of:

5.1 Coordination and service improvement

5.2 Staff services?

6. Is there a significant relationship between the respondent's demographic profile (age, sex, and employment status) and the key variables of the study, preparedness in physical set-up, utilization of technology, and event services?

1.6 Hypothesis

The hypothesis guided the study and was tested at the level of significance.

H0 There is no significant relationship among the preparedness in physical setup, utilization of technology, and events services of selected convention and event facilities in Butuan City**.**

1.7 Scope and Limitation

The study will focus on assessing the preparedness of convention and event facilities in Butuan City in accommodating Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, and Exhibitions (MICE). The variables will include: (1) Physical Set-Up; (2) Technology Utilization; and (3) Event Services, with emphasis on Coordination and Service Improvement. This study will be applied only to convention and event facilities within Butuan City and will not include suppliers, destination managers, or other local government stakeholders. The primary data source will be a researcher-made questionnaire that will be administered to the identified respondents. Accordingly, the study will allow for significant observations about

convention and event facility preparedness within a delineated geographic area, while being limited by the scope of respondents and the methodology that will be employed.

1.8 Definition of Terms

For a better understanding and classification, the following terms and words were operationally defined as follows:

Age. This term refers to the number of years the respondent has lived at the time of data collection and is used as a demographic characteristic.

Average Number of Attendees. This term refers to the usual number of respondents present in events hosted by the facility, categorized into one hundred attendees and below, one hundred one to two hundred fifty attendees, two hundred fifty-one to five hundred attendees, and five hundred one attendees and above.

Convention. This term refers to an organized and scheduled gathering of individuals from professional, academic, civic, or industry groups that require meeting rooms, public areas, audio-visual support, and coordinated event services.

Convention and Facilities. This term refers to hotels and convention centers in Butuan City capable of hosting meetings, incentives, conventions, and events. It refers to establishments such as Hotel Oazis, Balanghai Hotel and Convention Center, Chikara Dottie's Place, VCDU Prince Hotel Grand Convention Center, and Icon Suites and Convention Center Incorporated. It also refers to their physical set-up, utilization of technology, and event services.

Coordination and Service Improvement. This term refers to the systems and procedures provided by the facility, including room capacity information, single-stop assistance, feedback mechanisms, pre-arrival risk assessments, and communication of hygiene and distancing measures.

Employment Status. This term refers to the respondent's current work category, such as employed, unemployed, self-employed, part-time, or retired.

Event Services. This term refers to the assistance and supports the venue provides before, during, and after the event, including coordination efforts, enhanced service delivery, and responsiveness of staff.

Largest Type of Event Handled. This term refers to the most significant type of event the respondent or facility has handled, such as meetings, conventions or conferences, exhibitions or events, or training programs.

Light and Audio-Visual Operations. This term refers to the lighting systems and audio-visual equipment available in the venue, including stage lighting, audience lighting, projector and screen clarity, microphone quality, and trained personnel managing the controls.

Meeting Room and Public Areas. This term refers to the common spaces within the facility, such as restrooms, hallways, cafeterias, smoking areas, parking areas, drop-off and pick-up points, and sanitation stations. It refers to their cleanliness, ventilation, and signage.

Meetings and Function Rooms. This term refers to the rooms used for seminars, conferences, meetings, and workshops. It refers to their cleanliness, capacity, ventilation, layout, furnishings, and signage.

Other Services. This term refers to additional technological and administrative services provided by the facility, such as wireless internet access, contactless registration, contactless payment, photocopying, scanning, faxing, contact tracing, vaccination verification, and multilingual signage.

Power and Air Conditioning System. This term refers to the systems that provide electrical power and maintain indoor temperature and air movement. It refers to air exchange, cooling systems, emergency lighting, backup electrical supply, exhaust fans, universal electrical outlets, and air purification devices.

Preparedness in Physical Set-up. This term refers to the overall readiness of the venue's physical environment for hosting events. It refers to meeting rooms, public areas, and safety, security, and emergency facilities assessed based on standards aligned with the Association of Southeast Asian Nations Meeting, Incentive, Convention, and Events Venue Standards.

Safety, Security, Emergency Facilities. This term refers to the equipment and systems provided to ensure the safety of participants, including closed-circuit television, security personnel, fire protection equipment, evacuation procedures, isolation rooms, hygiene kits, and directional floor signs.

Sex. This term refers to the biological identification of respondents as male or female for demographic classification.

Staff Service. This term refers to the performance and conducts of personnel working in the venue, including competence, professionalism, communication skills, adherence to safety procedures, and ability to address guest concerns.

Utilization of Technology. This term refers to the technological systems used by the facility to support event operations, including lighting systems, audio-visual equipment, electrical power reliability, air conditioning performance, wireless internet access, contactless services, digital documentation, and quick response code-based verification.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter discusses the research design, research locale, research respondents, and research instrument used in the study. It also explains the ethical standards, data gathering procedure, and statistical treatment involved.

2.1 Research Design

The researchers will employ a quantitative research design to evaluate the preparedness of selected convention and event facilities in Butuan City in three areas: physical setup, technology usage, and event services.

The study will collect quantitative data through surveys from two groups: (a) internal operators (managers, event's organizers and front-office staff, safety personnel) and (b) external attendees (delegates/participants and client-organizers who attended events in the selected venues). This approach allows Analysis by respondent profile and supports comparisons across facilities. The survey will be anchored on Hernandez (2023) and patterned after a Philippine study on venue preparedness. An adapted questionnaire based on the ASEAN MICE Venue Standards (2018) and the World Travel & Tourism Council Global Protocols for the New Normal (2020) will be the primary data-collection tool.

2.2 Research Locale

This study will be conducted in Butuan City, Agusan del Norte, a growing hub for business, civic, and academic events in the Caraga Region. The locale aligns with the assessment of preparedness because hotels and convention facilities often host meetings, training sessions, conferences, and social events. In these settings, physical setup, technology use, and event services are visible and comparable.

The research will focus on five convention-capable establishments: Hotel Oazis (Oazis Hotel & Convention Center) on J.C. Aquino Avenue; Balanghai Hotel & Convention Center on Bacolod Street, Upper Doongan; Chikara Dottie's Place on J.C Aquino Avenue, Butuan City; VCDU Prince Hotel Grand Convention Center on Ilang- Ilang St. Villa Kananga, Butuan City and Icon Suites and Convention Center , Inc. on Butuan City. Each site offers operating conditions that are relevant to the study.

Placing the study across these locations enables a contextual assessment of readiness in the core areas. The environment supports systematic observation and comparison of (a) physical configuration (capacity, layout, safety, and movement), (b) technology use (lighting, audiovisual operations, connectivity, and power/HVAC uptime), and (c) event services (staffing, coordination, and guest assistance). Differences across sites in Butuan City will make the findings useful for venue managers, event planners, and other stakeholders.

2.3 Research Environment, Population and Sample

The sampling of participants was determined using a purposive sampling approach. This method was chosen because the study specifically required respondents who were directly involved in or exposed to the operations of convention and event facilities, either as venue personnel or as event participants. The initial sampling frame was based on the official list of Department of Tourism (DOT) accredited convention and event facilities in Butuan City. Formal letters of request were sent to thirteen (13) identified establishments; however, only five (5) facilities granted permission to participate. These five venues, namely Hotel Oazis, Balanghai Hotel and Convention Center, VCDU Prince Hotel Grand Convention Hall, Icon Suites and Convention Center, Inc., and Chikara Dottie's Place, therefore constituted the final research sites. Within each participating facility, respondents were selected based on specific inclusion criteria. These included managers, supervisors, and staff directly involved in event operations such as banquet, front office, technical, or safety personnel, as well as event attendees or client organizers who had direct experience with the venue's facilities and services. This approach ensured that responses were grounded in actual operational and experiential knowledge of the convention facilities. The use of purposive sampling allowed the researchers to gather relevant, experience-based data, which is appropriate for descriptive studies assessing facility preparedness.

Table 1. Distribution of the Respondents

Convention Facility	Population (Male)	Population (Female)	Population (Total)	Sample (Male)	Sample (Female)	Sample (Total)	% of Sample
Oasis Hotel and Convention Center	1,191	1,191	2,382	73	73	145	40.3
Balanghai Hotel and Convention Center	164	344	508	10	21	31	8.6
VCDU Prince Hotel Grand Convention Center	349	454	803	21	28	49	13.6
Icon Suites and Convention Center, Inc	81	39	120	5	2	7	2.0
Total	**1,785**	**2,028**	**3,813**	**109**	**124**	**232**	**64.5**

Category	Male		Female		Total	
	f	%	f	%	f	%
Hotel Staff	67	60.9	43	39.1	110	95.7
Managers	3	60.0	2	40.0	5	4.3
Total	**70**	**60.9**	**45**	**39.1**	**115**	**100.0**

Table 1 shows the distribution of respondents of the study

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

Research Instrument

The research instrument was adapted and modified from the questionnaire developed by Hernandez (2023) entitled *"Preparedness of Convention and Event Facilities in the New Normal in Batangas,"* originally used to assess the preparedness of convention and event facilities in Batangas. Modifications were necessary to ensure that the instrument aligned with the context of Butuan City, the objectives of the present study, and current MICE standards. Specifically, the instrument was modified in terms of variables and indicators. For Preparedness in Physical Set-Up, the indicators included meetings and function rooms (room capacity, layout flexibility, ventilation, and cleanliness), meeting rooms and public areas (hallways, restrooms, signage, crowd flow, and sanitation stations), and safety, security, and emergency facilities (emergency exits, fire equipment, CCTV, first aid stations, and evacuation plans). For Utilization of Technology, the indicators covered lighting and audio-visual operations (sound clarity, projection systems, and technical staff support), power and air conditioning systems

(backup power, temperature control, and air circulation), and other technological services (Wi-Fi stability, contactless registration, digital verification, and online support tools). For Event Services, the instrument emphasized coordination and service improvement (pre-event coordination, feedback mechanisms, and response to concerns) and staff services (professionalism, communication skills, responsiveness, and adherence to safety protocols). All items were rated using a four-point Likert scale (4–Strongly Agree to 1–Strongly Disagree).

The modified instrument will undergo expert validation to ensure clarity, relevance, and alignment with the ASEAN MICE Venue Standards (2018) and the World Travel & Tourism Council Global Protocols for the New Normal (2020). After validation, the instrument will be pilot tested among a small group of respondents who are similar to the actual study participants but are not part of the final sample. Results of the pilot test will be subjected to reliability testing (e.g., Cronbach's alpha), and necessary revisions will be made before final administration. These processes ensure that the questionnaire measures venue preparedness accurately and contextually for Butuan City.

Part I will gather the respondents' profiles, including age, sex, role or affiliation (such as venue staff, manager, attendee, or client), name of venue, the most significant type of event handled or attended (meeting, convention or conference, exhibition or event, or training), and the average number of attendees. Part II will measure the preparedness of the physical set-up, specifically meeting and function rooms, meeting and public areas, and safety, security, and emergency facilities. Part III will assess

operational preparedness by evaluating technology utilization such as lighting and audiovisual operations, power and air-conditioning systems, and other services, as well as event services, including coordination and service improvement and staff service.

The instrument will be used to assess the preparedness of convention and event facilities in Butuan City and will serve as a basis for guiding programs aimed at improving physical set-up, technology utilization, and service delivery across the selected venues.

2.5 Research Ethical Considerations

A. Protection of Intellectual Property Right (IPR)

This study will uphold intellectual property rights by strictly maintaining respondent anonymity throughout the research process. All secondary data, literature, and scholarly works incorporated into the study will be properly cited to acknowledge their original authors. The researchers' own ideas and outputs will also be protected in accordance with academic integrity guidelines.

B. Informed Consent

The respondents will be formally identified representatives of convention and facilities in Butuan City (e.g., managers, supervisors, or designated staff). The respondents will undergo a brief orientation conducted by the researchers to better understand the purpose of the study on facility preparedness for MICE, as well as the potential benefits and risks before agreeing to participate. The respondents will be informed of their right to withdraw from the study at any time

without any explanation. During the orientation, a written consent form will be distributed to each respondent to ensure they fully understand their rights.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

All personal and organizational information obtained during the study will be treated with strict confidentiality. The data will only be collected with explicit consent from the respondents through the informed consent form. All responses will be anonymized through assigned identification codes, and only the researchers will have access to the master list linking codes to respondents. Questionnaires will be administered under supervised conditions to safeguard respondent privacy. All data will be securely stored, and confidentiality will be maintained throughout the entirety of the research process.

D. Voluntary Participation and Freedom to Withdraw

Participation in this study will be completely voluntary. Respondents will be informed of their right to refuse or withdraw at any point without facing any negative consequences. Since no animals will be involved in the study, ethical considerations regarding animal use will not apply.

E. Minimization of Harm and Risk Management

The researchers will engage with the respondents respectfully and professionally to establish a safe and supportive environment throughout the study. Suppose any risks are associated, such as discomfort in providing organizational information. In that case, respondents will be referred to the appropriate support services

designated by their institution or the researchers' institution to ensure their well-being. After participation, researchers will provide a debriefing session to ensure no physical, psychological, or emotional harm occurs throughout the research process. The study will not involve animal subjects; the 3Rs principles of replacement, reduction, and refinement will not apply.

F. Beneficence and Contribution to Knowledge

This study will contribute to a better understanding of the preparedness of convention and event facilities in Butuan City to accommodate MICE events. The study's findings will be available upon request from the respondents. The benefits of the study will focus on improving facility readiness and service coordination and will be based on the results of the study.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

Respondents will be selected using well-defined, fair inclusion and exclusion criteria to ensure the selection process aligns with the study's objectives. Respondents from diverse backgrounds and facility types (e.g., hotels with function spaces, convention centers, and standalone event venues) will be included in a fair and nondiscriminatory manner. The list provided by the Department of Tourism (DOT) will serve as the initial sampling frame. The Researchers issued formal letters of approval to thirteen (13) establishments; however, only five (5) of these establishments responded to the communication. These five responding establishments will be considered as potential participants,

provided that they meet the study's inclusion criteria. Establishments that declined participation, either by explicitly refusing or by failing to respond to the formal communication, will be excluded from the study.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

Data collection and Analysis will be conducted using standardized methods to ensure accurate and reliable results. Initially, the researchers will submit a formal request to the relevant local offices (e.g., City Tourism Office/DOT regional listings) and facility management to obtain the complete list of eligible facilities and authorized respondents for the study. All findings will undergo careful review to avoid potential bias or error, and no limitations will be identified in the study.

I. Transparency and Honesty in Reporting

The findings of the study will be reported honestly, with no manipulation or alteration of data. All sources such as academic references will be properly cited and acknowledged to ensure respect for intellectual property rights and uphold ethical research standards. This study will utilize some AI tools to support various aspects of the research. There will be no potential conflict of interest involved in the study.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

No patented materials will be involved in this study. All copyrighted materials including references, will be properly cited in accordance with intellectual property laws. The researchers will ensure that all sources are appropriately

acknowledged, maintaining academic integrity and avoiding any form of plagiarism.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials

The researchers will inform the respondents about the possible risks and potential benefits of the study, ensuring that an informed consent form will be provided**.** If any significant risks are present, such as emotional, physical, or psychological risks, an appropriate health monitoring program and emotional support services will be available.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Other Related Technology

The researchers will use digital technologies throughout the research process, including finding reliable articles to maintain the study's accuracy and credibility. AI tools, such as ChatGPT**,** will be utilized to assist in summarizing statements and enhancing the quality of the study. Platforms such as Google Scholar, Elicit, and Typeset.io will be used to identify supporting studies, ensuring the reliability and credibility of the research. Additionally, Grammarly will be used to ensure that the research report adheres to proper grammar and clarity standards. The responsible use of technologies will help maintain the integrity of the study.

M. Ethical Clearance and Institutional Approval

The research will obtain ethical approval from the Institutional Review Board of Saint Michael College of Caraga, confirming its compliance with all relevant

guidelines on the protection of respondents, data privacy, and intellectual property rights.

2.6 Data Gathering Procedure

In gathering the data, the researchers will begin by sending a formal request letter to the Department of Tourism in Butuan City to obtain and confirm the official list of accredited convention and event facilities in the area. Once the endorsed list is received, the researchers will personally deliver permission letters to the managers of the selected venues Hotel Oazis, Icon Suites and Convention Center, Inc., Balanghai Hotel and Convention Center, Chikara Dottie's Place, and VCDU Prince Hotel Grand Convention Hall to secure their approval to conduct the study.

After all permissions are granted, the researchers will finalize the research instrument, which will be anchored on the indicators of the ASEAN MICE Venue Standards and the Global Protocols for the New Normal of the World Travel and Tourism Council. The instrument will undergo an expert validity review to ensure clarity, accuracy, and relevance to the objectives of the study. Following validation, pilot testing will be conducted, and the results will be submitted to the statistician to establish the instrument's reliability and finalize the questionnaire. Once the instrument is validated and completed, the researchers will coordinate with each participating venue to schedule the data collection. During the scheduled visits, the researchers will administer the questionnaires to the identified respondents, including internal operators such as managers, event or banquet staff, front-office personnel,

audiovisual or information technology staff, and safety officers, as well as external attendees such as delegates, participants, or client-organizers present during events. The researchers will ensure voluntary participation and adherence to ethical research standards throughout the process. After the data collection is finished, the researchers will tally, encode, and organize all responses for statistical processing. The encoded dataset will then be submitted to the statistician to ensure computational accuracy, verify data quality, and generate statistical tables aligned with the study's variables. Once the processed data are received, the researchers will analyze, interpret, and discuss the findings based on the statement of the problem and the study's domains: physical set-up, technology utilization, and event services. The results will be synthesized to draw conclusions and formulate recommendations on the preparedness of convention and event facilities in Butuan City.

2.7 Data Analysis Plan and Procedure

Statistical Treatment

In presenting, analyzing, and interpreting data, the researcher used the following statistical test, namely.

Frequency and Percentage – to describe the respondents' demographic profile (SOP 1).

Mean – to determine the level of preparedness in Physical Set-up (SOP 2).

Mean – to determine the extent of utilization in Light & Audio Visual / Power & Air Conditioning / Other Services (SOP 3).

Mean – to determine the level of Event Services (Coordination & Service Improvement; Staff Service) (SOP 4).

Correlational Analysis – to examine significant relationships among Physical Setup, Utilization of Technology, and Event Services (SOP 5).

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